

A CARTER COLE & ASSOCIATES WORKBOOK

From Starter to Builder

30 Days to Stop Starting Over
and Start Building With Intention

*“You don’t need another idea.
You need a foundation.”*

INSIDE THE WORKBOOK

- 01 The Starter’s Assessment
- 02 The Builder’s Blueprint
- 03 The Foundation — systems, not goals
- 04 30 Days of Building
- 05 From Starter to Builder

Lashanda Carter

FOUNDER



30-DAY WORKBOOK · PRINT OR DIGITAL



A Note From Lashanda

I've always been a starter.

Give me an idea and I'll run with it - find the clients, bring in the revenue, make it work. I've done it six times.

But here's what I learned: starting was never my problem. Building the foundation was.

I hired people. Paid them well. But without systems, the money went out faster than it came in. I was paying everyone but myself. And when you're worn out and not seeing the return, you give up. Not because it couldn't work - but because you couldn't see how to make it work for you.

I spent years being the starter.

Now I'm learning to be the builder.

That's what this workbook is about.

- Lashanda Carter

Smart Tax IQ | Carter Cole & Associates LLC

How to Use This Workbook

This workbook is designed for 30 days. But it's not a race. You can move faster or slower - just don't skip the writing parts. That's where the real work happens.

The structure:

Part 1: The Starter's Assessment - Where are you now?

Part 2: The Builder's Blueprint - What are you building?

Part 3: The Foundation - Systems, not just goals

Part 4: 30 Days of Building - One focus per day

Part 5: From Starter to Builder - The mindset shift

Print it or use it digitally. Write in the spaces. Color in the trackers. Check the boxes. Make it yours.

01

THE STARTER'S ASSESSMENT

*Before you build, you have to know where
you're starting from.*

What Am I Really Building?

Write down what you're actually building. Not what sounds good.
Not what someone else expects. What is YOUR vision?

"Hobby" ←————→ "Empire"

Circle where you are now. Then circle where you want to be in 30 days.

Reflection: Is this a business, a side hustle, or a movement?

☐ Business ☐ Side hustle ☐ Movement

What Does Freedom Look Like for Me?

Freedom means something different to everyone. Define yours.

Freedom looks like having _____

Freedom looks like not having to _____

Freedom looks like being able to _____

Freedom looks like feeling _____

Freedom Priority Ranking (1 = most important, 5 = least)

Time freedom Rank: _____

Financial freedom Rank: _____

Location freedom Rank: _____

Creative freedom Rank: _____

Relationship freedom Rank: _____

Look at what you ranked #1. What are you doing THIS WEEK to build toward it?

What Season of Life Am I In?

Every season requires a different strategy. You can't build like someone with no responsibilities if you have three kids, a full-time job, and a household to run.

Current Season Assessment

Energy level:	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Available time:	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Mental clarity:	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Support system:	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Financial stability:	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

I am currently: _____

My responsibilities include: _____

My available time to build is: _____

My biggest constraint right now is: _____

What would it look like to build WITH your current season instead of against it?

Builder Alignment Audit

You need to cut out the naysayers. But first - look at who's actually helping you build vs. who's just along for the ride.

The Builder Alignment Audit

Name	Supports my vision?	Adds to my foundation?	Keep / Cut
☐	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Keep ☐ Cut
☐	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Keep ☐ Cut
☐	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Keep ☐ Cut
☐	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Keep ☐ Cut
☐	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Keep ☐ Cut
☐	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Keep ☐ Cut
☐	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Keep ☐ Cut

Who actually helps you build? Who's just noise?

I am protecting my foundation by cutting: _____

What Am I No Longer Willing to Carry?

Clarity comes from subtraction as much as addition. Name what you're done carrying.

The "I'm Done" List

	What I'm done carrying	What I'll do instead
☐		
☐		
☐		
☐		
☐		
☐		

Energy Audit (fill in circles, 1-5)

People/relationships	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Old business ideas	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Guilt about past failures	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Other people's expectations	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Perfectionism	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Fear of judgment	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

This week, I am letting go of: _____

And replacing it with: _____

02

THE BUILDER'S BLUEPRINT

*Get your vision out of your head and onto
paper.*

30-Day Business Vision

Where do you want your business to be in 30 days? Be specific.
Vague goals produce vague results.

Revenue Goal: \$ _____

New Clients/Customers: _____

New Skill to Learn: _____

System to Build: _____

One Thing to Stop Doing: _____

One Thing to Start Doing: _____

Vision Statement (one sentence):

Vision Check:

- ☐ I can picture this clearly
- ☐ This scares me a little (good)
- ☐ This is achievable in 30 days
- ☐ I've written it down where I can see it daily

Income Goals

30-Day Total: \$ _____

Weekly Breakdown:

Week	Income Goal	Actual	Difference
Week 1	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Week 2	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Week 3	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Week 4	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____

Where Is This Money Coming From?

Product/Service	Price	# to Sell	Monthly Total
	\$ _____	_____	\$ _____
	\$ _____	_____	\$ _____
	\$ _____	_____	\$ _____
	\$ _____	_____	\$ _____
	\$ _____	_____	\$ _____

Reflection: What's the ONE income stream that matters most right now?

Personal Goals

Your business goals and personal goals are connected. Don't separate them.

30-Day Personal Goals:

☐

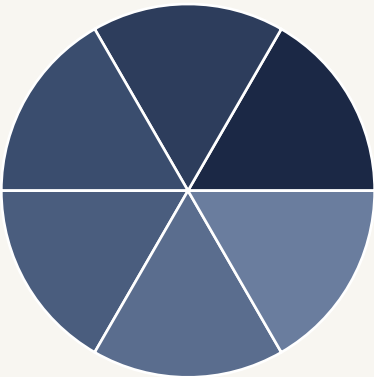
☐

☐

Life Balance Wheel

Rate each area 1-10. Color in the wheel section from center outward.

- Health/Wellness: ____ /10
- Relationships: ____ /10
- Personal Growth: ____ /10
- Finances: ____ /10
- Home Environment: ____ /10
- Joy/Fun: ____ /10



Business Goals

30-Day Business Goals:

☐

☐

☐

Goal Breakdown by Category:

Category	Specific Goal

Milestone Tracker (check each as you hit it):

☐ Day 5 ->

☐ Day 10 ->

☐ Day 15 ->

☐ Day 20 ->

☐ Day 25 ->

☐ Day 30 ->

My Why

The 'why' is what keeps you going when the excitement fades. Get real with this one.

Why does this matter to you?

Who are you building this for?

☐ Myself ☐ My children/family ☐ My community ☐ A specific group: _____

What happens if you DON'T build this?

"When you know your why, your how becomes clear."

03

THE FOUNDATION

You don't need another idea. You need a foundation.

Why Foundation Matters

"Starting isn't the problem. Building the foundation is."

A business without a foundation is a business that depends on you for everything. The right paperwork. The right insurance. Organized accounting. Proper business structure. Documented systems. Automated processes. And consistency.

"When you don't have systems in place, the business depends on you for every little thing. And when you're doing everything, eventually something has to give."

The 6 Pillars of a Foundation:

1. Legal Structure - Is your business properly set up?
2. Financial Systems - Is your accounting organized?
3. Operations - Are your processes documented?
4. Consistency - Do you show up every day?
5. Boundaries - Have you cut out the distractions?
6. Mindset - Have you changed your whole mindset?

Which pillar is weakest right now? _____

Which pillar will you focus on first? _____

Weekly CEO Planning Page

You're the CEO. Plan like one. Fill this out every Sunday or Monday morning.

Week of: _____

This Week's #1 Priority:

Top 3 Business Tasks:

- ☐ 1. _____
- ☐ 2. _____
- ☐ 3. _____

Top 3 Personal Tasks:

- ☐ 1. _____
- ☐ 2. _____
- ☐ 3. _____

Money Focus This Week: _____

One Thing I Will NOT Do This Week: _____

Friday Check-In - How did I do this week?

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

9

10

Daily Priority Sheet

Print multiple copies. Fill this out every morning. Takes 2 minutes.

Date: _____

The ONE thing that must get done today:

Secondary Tasks (max 3):

- ☐ 1. _____
- ☐ 2. _____
- ☐ 3. _____

Morning Intention: _____

Evening Reflection (fill in before bed):

- ☐ I completed my #1 priority
- ☐ I'm proud of myself today

What I accomplished: _____

What I learned: _____

Energy today

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	----

Business Task Tracker

Map your week. Check off tasks as you complete them.

Task	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Weekly Review:

What moved the needle? _____

What wasted time? _____

What to adjust next week? _____

Content Planning Page

Plan your content for the week. Aim for 60% personal/behind-the-scenes, 40% business/expertise.

Week of: _____

Content Ratio Check:

	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Personal/BTS	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Business/Exp	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Daily Content Plan:

Mon	Platform: _____	Idea: _____	[] Posted
Tue	Platform: _____	Idea: _____	[] Posted
Wed	Platform: _____	Idea: _____	[] Posted
Thu	Platform: _____	Idea: _____	[] Posted
Fri	Platform: _____	Idea: _____	[] Posted
Sat	Platform: _____	Idea: _____	[] Posted
Sun	Platform: _____	Idea: _____	[] Posted

Money & Business Tracker

30-Day Revenue:

Product/Service	Amount	Check
	\$ _____	
	\$ _____	
	\$ _____	
	\$ _____	

TOTAL IN: \$ _____

30-Day Expenses:

Expense	Amount	Check
	\$ _____	
	\$ _____	
	\$ _____	
	\$ _____	

TOTAL OUT: \$ _____

TOTAL IN: \$_____

TOTAL OUT: \$_____

NET PROFIT: \$ _____

30-Day Money Goal Tracker

Goal: \$_____

Color in one segment for every 10% of your goal you hit.

--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--

04

30 DAYS OF BUILDING

One focus per day. No excuses. Don't break the chain.

30-Day Progress Tracker

Color in one square each day you complete the prompt. Don't break the chain.

1	2	3	4	5	6
7	8	9	10	11	12
13	14	15	16	17	18
19	20	21	22	23	24
25	26	27	28	29	30

"Don't break the chain. Show up every day."

Day 1 - Write your vision in one sentence.

Today, write the clearest, simplest version of what you're building. One sentence. No jargon. No fluff.

☐ Done. It's written where I can see it.

Day 2 - Identify your one revenue stream.

You can't build five things at once. Pick ONE. Write it down. Commit to it for 30 days.

My ONE revenue stream for 30 days: _____

Day 3 - Tell five people what you're building.

Out loud. Not in a post. In a conversation. Practice saying it until it feels natural.

☐ Who I told	Their reaction
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	

Day 4 - Audit your time.

Write down every hour of your day yesterday. Where did your time actually go?

Hour	What I Did
6 AM	
7 AM	
8 AM	
9 AM	
10 AM	
11 AM	
12 PM	
1 PM	
2 PM	
3 PM	
4 PM	
5 PM	
6 PM	
7 PM	
8 PM	
9 PM	
10 PM	

What would you change?

Day 5 - Do the hardest task first.

Whatever you've been avoiding - do it today before anything else.

Relief after completing 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Day 6 - Set up one system.

Pick one thing in your business that's messy. Create a simple system for it today.

- ☐ System is documented
- ☐ System is in place

Day 7 - Weekly Reflection

What worked this week? What didn't? What did you learn about yourself?

Week 1 confidence:

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

9

10

Day 8 - Post one piece of content.

Not perfect. Not polished. Just posted.

- ☐ Posted
- ☐ It felt scary but I did it anyway

Day 9 - Reach out to one potential client.

Direct message, email, phone call - your choice. Initiate the conversation.

☐ I followed up if needed

Day 10 - Track your money.

Write down every dollar that came in and went out this week.

\$ _____ Money IN
\$ _____
\$ _____
\$ _____
Total: \$ _____

\$ _____ Money OUT
\$ _____
\$ _____
\$ _____
Total: \$ _____

Day 11 - Learn one new thing.

Read an article, watch a video, take a lesson.

☐ I applied it within 24 hours

Day 12 - Declutter your workspace.

Your environment affects your energy. Spend 30 minutes clearing your space.

- ☐ Desk cleared
- ☐ Files organized
- ☐ Digital space cleaned

Day 13 - Write your elevator pitch.

30 seconds. What do you do? Who do you help? What's the result?

Practice saying it out loud 5 times:

☐

☐

☐

☐

☐

Day 14 - Weekly Reflection

Two weeks in. What's changing? What's still stuck?

Week 2 momentum:

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

9

10

Day 15 - Ask for feedback.

Show someone your product, service, or content. Ask: "What's one thing I could improve?"

How did it feel to receive feedback?

4

5

6

7

8

9

10

Day 16 - Create one offer.

What can you sell right now?

What I'm selling:

Who it's for:

The price:

The result:

- ☐ Offer is written down
- ☐ I've told at least one person about it

Day 17 - Rest intentionally.

Not laziness - rest. Take a walk. Sit in silence.

Rest quality:

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

9

10

Day 18 - Review your goals.

Look at your 30-day goals from Part 2. Are you on track?

Goal	On Track?	Adjustment
	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Somewhat	
	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Somewhat	
	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Somewhat	

Day 19 - Connect with someone ahead of you.

Find someone doing what you want to do. Reach out. Ask one good question.

Day 20 - Batch create.

Spend 2 hours creating content, planning, or prepping.

Productivity:

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

9

10

Day 21 - Weekly Reflection

Three weeks in. What habit have you built? What habit is still missing?

Week 3 discipline: 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Day 22 - Raise your prices or standards.

If you have an offer, is the price right? If not, what standard are you holding yourself to?

My new standard: _____

Day 23 - Say no to something.

A commitment, a distraction, a bad idea. Say no and protect your time.

Day 24 - Share your story.

Post or write something real about your journey. Not the highlight reel
- the real part.

- ☐ Posted
- ☐ It was vulnerable and I did it anyway

Day 25 - Review your numbers.

Money in, money out, reach, engagement, clients.

Revenue this month	
New clients/customers	
Social media reach	
Content posted	
Net profit	

Day 26 - Plan your next 30 days.

What's the focus for the next month?

Priority	Why It Matters

Day 27 - Celebrate one win.

Big or small. Actually celebrate it.

How proud am I of myself?

3

4

5

6

7

8

9

10

Day 28 - Identify your biggest lesson.

What did these 30 days teach you about yourself, your business, and your habits?

Day 29 - Write a letter to your future self.

Where do you want to be in 6 months? What would she tell you right now?

Dear Future Me, ...

Day 30 - From Starter to Builder

You did 30 days. What changed? What will you keep doing? What will you let go of? Are you a starter or a builder now?

Starter energy:	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Builder energy:	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

05

FROM STARTER TO BUILDER

The mindset shift that changes everything.

The Mindset Shift

"I've been the starter. Now I'm learning to be the builder."

A starter chases the next idea. A builder lays the foundation first.
A starter figures things out as they go. A builder has systems before they launch. A starter does everything themselves. A builder creates something that doesn't fall apart when they step away.

The Starter vs. The Builder

The Starter	The Builder
Chases the next idea	Builds the foundation first
Figures it out as they go	Has systems before launching
Does everything themselves	Creates something that runs without them
Consistency fades	Consistency is non-negotiable
Depends on motivation	Depends on discipline
Holds it all together alone	Builds something that holds itself

Where are you on the scale?

"Starter" ←————→ "Builder"

What's one thing you need to change to move toward builder?

Confidence

Confidence isn't a feeling. It's a decision you make before you feel ready.

What's one thing you've been waiting to feel 'confident enough' to do?

This week, I will: _____

Confidence Meter - rate BEFORE and AFTER:

Before:

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

9

10

After:

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

9

10

"I don't wait for confidence. I build it through action."

Discipline

Motivation gets you started. Discipline keeps you going.

What's the one discipline that would change everything for you?

30-Day Discipline Tracker

1	2	3	4	5	6
7	8	9	10	11	12
13	14	15	16	17	18
19	20	21	22	23	24
25	26	27	28	29	30

For the next 30 days, I will _____ every day.

Self-Talk

The way you speak to yourself becomes the ceiling on what you build.

Write down 3 things you say to yourself when things get hard. Be honest.

1. "_____"

2. "_____"

3. "_____"

Now rewrite each one - the way you'd speak to a friend:

1. "_____"

2. "_____"

3. "_____"

Self-Talk Awareness Tracker (one week):

[illegible]

Boundaries

You need to cut out the naysayers and the people who don't believe in you. Your business needs boundaries to survive. So do you.

Where are you saying yes when you mean no?

Boundary Assessment (1-10):

Family:	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Clients:	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Friends:	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Yourself:	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Social media:	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

This week, I will set or hold one boundary. It is:

- ☐ I communicated it clearly
- ☐ I held it even when it was uncomfortable

Consistency

Consistency is the underrated superpower. It's not flashy. It's not exciting. But it's what separates people who build from people who wish.

Where have you been inconsistent?

What would change if you showed up consistently for 30 days?

I will show up for _____ every day for 30 days.

30-Day Consistency Grid:

1	2	3	4	5	6
7	8	9	10	11	12
13	14	15	16	17	18
19	20	21	22	23	24
25	26	27	28	29	30

Believing in Yourself

You gotta believe in yourself. You gotta change your whole mindset.

What do you actually believe about yourself right now?

What do you NEED to believe to become the builder?

The Mindset Shift Tracker

Old belief (Starter)	New belief (Builder)

I am becoming the woman who can hold what she's building.

Celebrating Progress

You're so focused on how far you have to go that you forget how far you've come.

List 5 things you've accomplished - big or small - in the last year:

☐

☐

☐

☐

☐

How would your life change if you celebrated yourself the way you celebrate others?

This week, I'm celebrating: _____

How: _____

How often do I celebrate my wins?

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

9

10

(If this is below 5, make it a priority this month.)

You did 30 days.

That's not nothing. That's the beginning of something most people never start - a business built on a foundation, not a feeling.

You started as a starter. You're leaving as a builder.

Keep this workbook. Come back to it. Reset the daily sheets. The woman who finishes this workbook isn't the same one who started it.

You don't need another idea. You need a foundation. And you just spent 30 days building one.

Keep building.

- **Lashanda Carter**

Smart Tax IQ | Carter Cole & Associates LLC

cartercoleandassociates.com

[@lashandacarter](https://www.instagram.com/lashandacarter)